



StumbleUpon updated for Android

StumbleUpon app for Android was updated recently with a good looking homepage, previews, filters, new sharing options and something called as StumbleDNA

Samsung snubs WinRT

According to reports, Samsung has scrapped plans for releasing its Windows RT based tablet in the U.S.

Nirbhaya, Fight Back and more...

January saw a lot of women's safety apps gain publicity. Here we also take a look at these SOS guardians and some SMS replacement apps

Nimish Sawant

nimish.sawant@thinkdigit.com

The Delhi rape case which shocked the nation led to a lot of protests nation-wide and has really got everyone talking about harassment of women which is so rampant in our country. In response to the need of the hour, app developers have come out with innovative apps which can be used by women in distress. While we saw some brand new apps launched in the last month, there were some apps which got much deserved recognition as the issue of women's safety was on every responsible citizen's mind.

Nirbhaya

An app named after the symbolic name that was given to the deceased victim, was launched by a Pune-based company SmartCloud tech. It sends a distress message or allows the user to call a contact group specified by the user in an emergency situation. On the home screen of the app, you have a set of five buttons, each of which you assign a group of contacts to send message or call in case of an emergency. Apart from local police authorities, hospitals, you can have your close rel-



atives on the Groups. You can assign different groups for different sorts of emergencies. For instance for family emergencies, you group can have close family members; for accidents you can have local hospitals on your list and so on. The message is sent along with the users current location.

At present it is only available on the Google Play Store (<http://goo.gl/Jvzbh>) but will be coming on the Apple Store and Windows store soon. The app is thankfully free of cost.

MeAgainstRape

Android software developers Gunwant Battashe (23), engineer Anup Unnikrishanan (24) and graphic designer Jayesh Bankar (23) from Nashik have developed an Android application – Me Against Rape – which is free app to help women in distress by allowing them to send a message with the location co-ordinates or call a predefined number registered by the user. It also features a spy-mode which activates video and voice recording to act as evidence against eve-teasers. Its location log feature when activated, sends across the users location co-ordinates every 10 minutes, so that the receiving party is always clued in on the users location.

It is available for free on the Android app store (<http://goo.gl/8J7tW>)

Fightback

This app, developed by Mahindra Group, company CanvasM, allows user to send SOS message via SMS, e-mail

and Facebook at the press of a single key. It was initially available for ₹100, but can now be downloaded for free from the



Android app store. It enables users to push a central button and generate a security alert, which then uses communication channels such as SMS, emails and Facebook to give out panic message alongwith the exact location of the user.

It is available for free on the Google Play Store (<http://goo.gl/GaZ4m>)

Sentinel Personal Security

This is an old app but quite relevant in the times we live in. It works just like the other apps – sending SMSes and making calls to the concerned people in case of emergency after the app is activated. It also has certain non-manual methods to send alerts – if phone is switched off without logging our from Sentinel, when the phone goes out of coverage



area, when the phone battery is low and if the phone is forcibly destroyed. The user's last known location is sent via SMS or email to her well-wishers who can then take the necessary action.

This app is selling for ₹50 on the Google Play Store (<http://goo.gl/Y4PIy>)

SOS app of a different kind

Microsoft has announced a cross-platform app powered by Windows Azure called HelpBridge. It is an app which allows you to both ask for help as well as offer help in case of a natural disaster. This app is available on the Google Play store, Apple iTunes App Store and Windows Phone Store. At the moment it is only available in the US, but we should see Microsoft expanding support to other countries soon.

The HelpBridge app allows you to notify a group of friends or relatives from your contacts in case of an emergency. On your command, the app will send messages over email or SMS to the people who you have nominated to be notified during emergencies. The app also allows you to send a status update on your Facebook timeline and with your permission send across your precise location as well. Absence of Twitter is kind of surprising.

The other function of the app allows you to send across help in the form of money, supplies or even volunteer work in disaster prone areas. You can donate cash using PayPal and supplies can be sent to relief organisations directly.